CS5610

GROUP 26 WEB DEVELOPMENT

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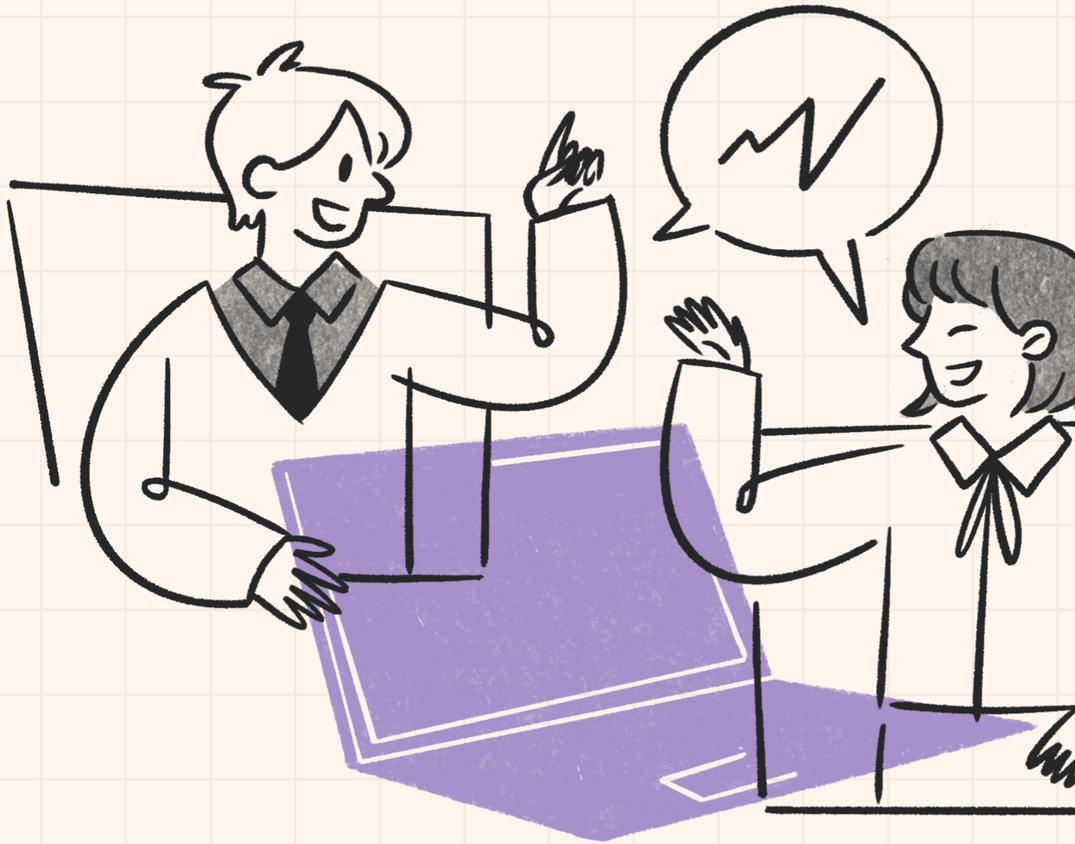
ROASTMYIDEA

PITCH YOUR IDEA. THE INTERNET DECIDES.



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OBJECTIVE

A COMMUNITY PLATFORM WHERE USERS PITCH STARTUP IDEAS, SIDE PROJECTS, OR ANY CONCEPT AND THE INTERNET DECIDES IF THEY ARE WORTH BUILDING

USERS ROAST IDEAS WITH CRITIQUES, DEFEND THEM WITH COUNTER-ARGUMENTS, AND BACK THEM WITH VIRTUAL ROASTCOIN. AFTER 7 DAYS A VERDICT IS REVEALED: FIREPROOF, TORCHED, OR LUKEWARM

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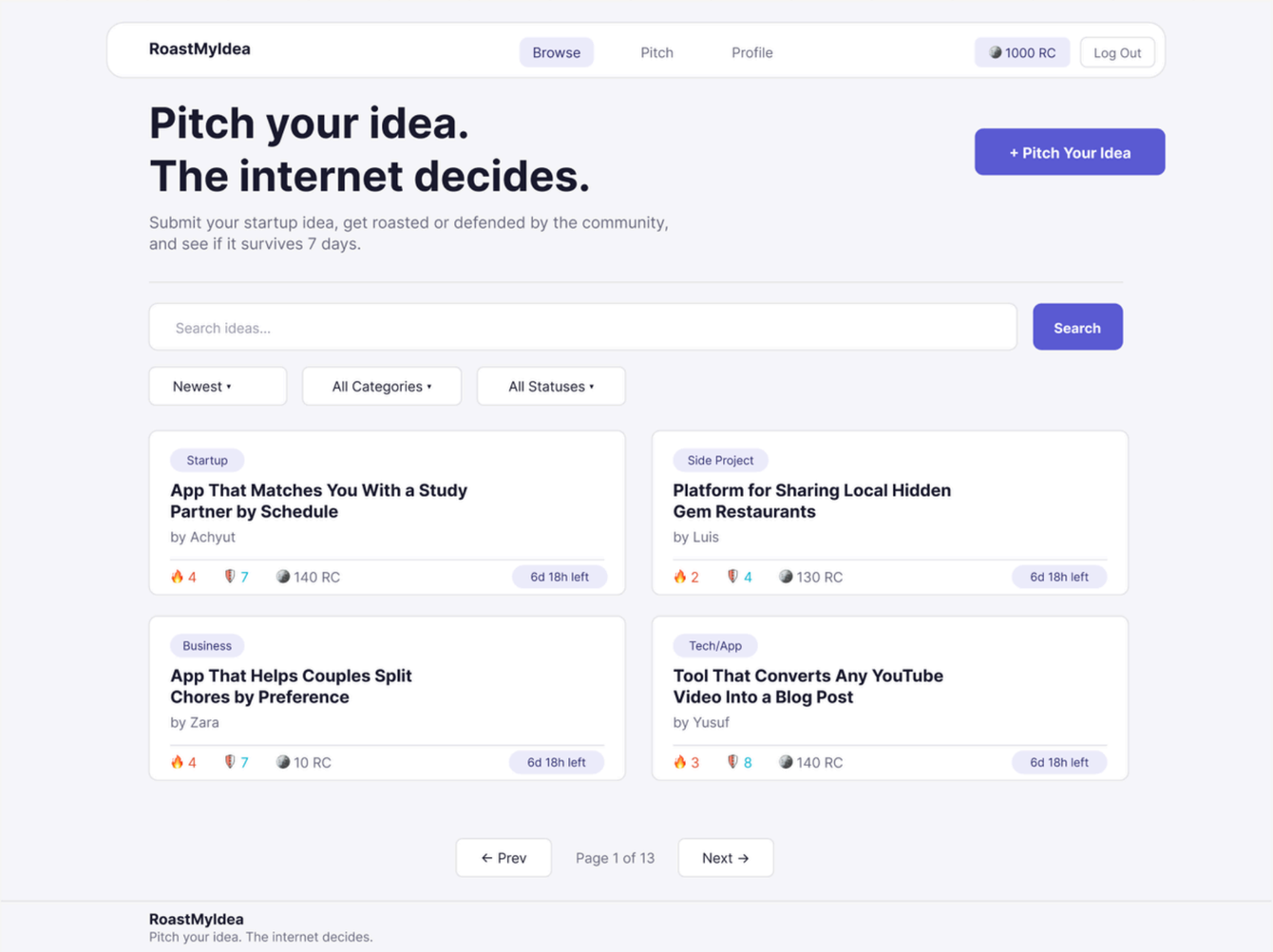
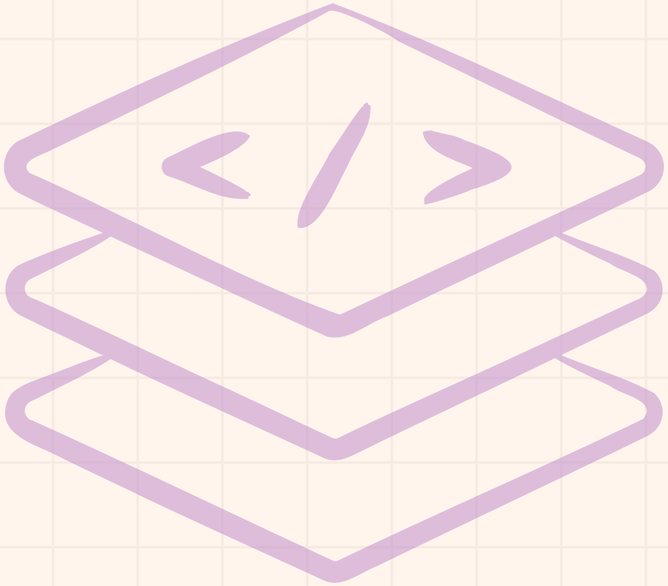
DESIGN AND MOCKUPS



FIGMA LINK

TECHNOLOGIES USED

- NODE.JS + EXPRESS (REST API, ESM FORMAT)
- MONGODB ATLAS WITH NATIVE DRIVER (NO MONGOOSE)
- REACT 18
- PASSPORT.JS WITH JWT + LOCAL STRATEGIES
- DEPLOYED ON VERCEL AS SERVERLESS FUNCTION



WHAT WE'RE PROUD OF

- We built a full gamified verdict system where roast and defense upvotes determine whether an idea is FIREPROOF, TORCHED, or LUKEWARM and RoastCoin payouts are processed automatically across all five collections
- We implemented keyset pagination with a compound sort tiebreaker on _id so the browse page stays stable across all five sort fields without skipping or duplicating results when new ideas are added
- We seeded the database with over 2200 records including 30 users, 150 ideas, 600 roasts, and 1050 defenses with realistic relationships, denormalized counts, and proper verdict states

WHAT WE STRUGGLED THE MOST WITH

- Getting the verdict service to correctly calculate payouts by summing upvotes across roasts and defenses for an idea and then atomically updating RC balances for the pitcher and all backers depending on the outcome
- Enforcing side-picking so a user cannot roast and defend the same idea, combined with the 5 minute edit grace period that blocks edits once a roast or defense has been upvoted or replied to
- Configuring the MongoDB $text index with field weights so that title matches rank higher than pitch body matches while keyset pagination still works correctly when switching between sort and search modes

DEMO

- Link: https://roastmyidea-nine.vercel.app/
- A quick walkthrough: browse ideas -> log in -> read an idea detail -> invest RoastCoin -> post a roast -> defend a roast -> upvote -> pitch your own idea -> view profile stats

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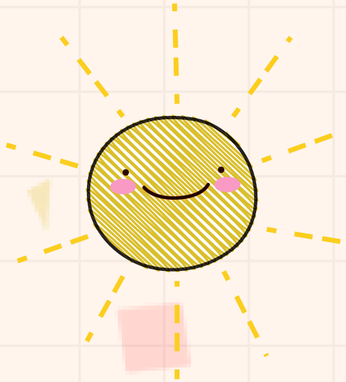

THANK YOU